Temco Platform

Docs center: the redesign · built Nov 12, 2026

Docs center: the redesign

One consolidated design for the documentation center. It supersedes the layout sections of `app-flow.md`, `authoring-flow.md` and `extension-design.md`, which contradict each other. Nothing here is built yet.

1. The model

```
Sources → Temco Platform (authoring) → Product package → Temco Learn (website)
repos, pdf,   projects · AI · review      products/<id>/      search · downloads · ve
word, chm                                 manifest.json
                                          docs/ api/ guides/ assets/ releases/
```

System	Job	Where
Temco Platform	where people work: projects, sources, AI drafts, review, generate	this repository
Product package	the unit of exchange; a plug-in the portal discovers	`products/<id>/`
Temco Learn	the reader's MSDN-style portal	the `temco-learn` repository
DocFX	one pluggable build engine; CHM and PDF are other exporters	invoked by Build, never a surface

Vocabulary. Project (a `documents` row) → Section (the registry's *area*) → Folder (its *chapter*, nestable) → Page. Versions come from the project's releases. A `products` table is added only if several versions must be open at once.

Truth rule. Markdown and `registry.json` in the repository are the content. `catalog.sqlite` is a register (projects, sources, builds, releases, drafts, caches) and never holds a second copy of page text, except a draft not yet accepted.

2. Journey

TEXT

```
A LAUNCH ─► B START PAGE ─► C CREATE PROJECT ─► D EMPTY PROJECT ─► E ADD PAGES
                                                                        │
  I RELEASE ◄─ H PUBLISH ◄─ G NEEDS YOU / AI LOOP ◄─ F EDIT / CAPTURE ◄─┘
```

A. First launch

TEXT

```
┌──┬──────────────────────────┬──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
│ ▤◀ │ DOCS                   │  Welcome to Temco Docs
│  │  No project yet          │   ┌─ Start ──────────────┐  ┌─ Bring in existing ─
│  │  [ ＋ Create a project ] │   │ ＋ New project       │  │ Word · RTF · CHM · H
│  │  [ ⇩ Import a doc set  ] │   │ ▤ From a template    │  │ A folder of Markdow
│  │  [ ⎇ Open a repository ] │   │ ⎇ From a repository  │  │ A git repository
│  │                          │   └──────────────────────┘  └──────────────────────
├──┴──────────────────────────┴──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
│ catalog.sqlite created · default organisation written
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
```

B. Start page (projects exist; shown in the editor, not a container)

TEXT

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ Temco Docs                                                  ＋ New project │
│ RECENT PROJECTS                                                           │
│  ▤ T3000 Documentation   v13.0   3 sources   built 12:04 ✓   [ Open ] [ ⋯ ]  │
│  ▤ BACnet Tools          v1.2    1 source    never built     [ Open ] [ ⋯ ]  │
│ NEEDS YOU (all projects)                RECENT ACTIVITY                   │
│  ⚑ 2 drafts waiting       T3000          12:04 build site ✓ T3000          │
│  📷 1 screenshot to place  T3000          11:40 capture placed → Scaling    │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

C. Create a project (4 steps)

```
1 ORIGIN   ◉ Blank · ○ From a template · ○ From a repository · ○ Import a document set
2 BASICS   Name [T3000 Documentation]  Version [13.0]  Owner [alice ▾]  Audience [devel
3 SOURCES  ☑ ⎇ t3000webview [main ▾] [src/**]   ☑ ⎇ t3000-esp [main ▾]   + GitHub o
4 OUTPUTS  Engine [DocFX ▾]  ☑ Website ☑ PDF ☑ CHM ☑ Search index ☐ AI index  →  Rev
```

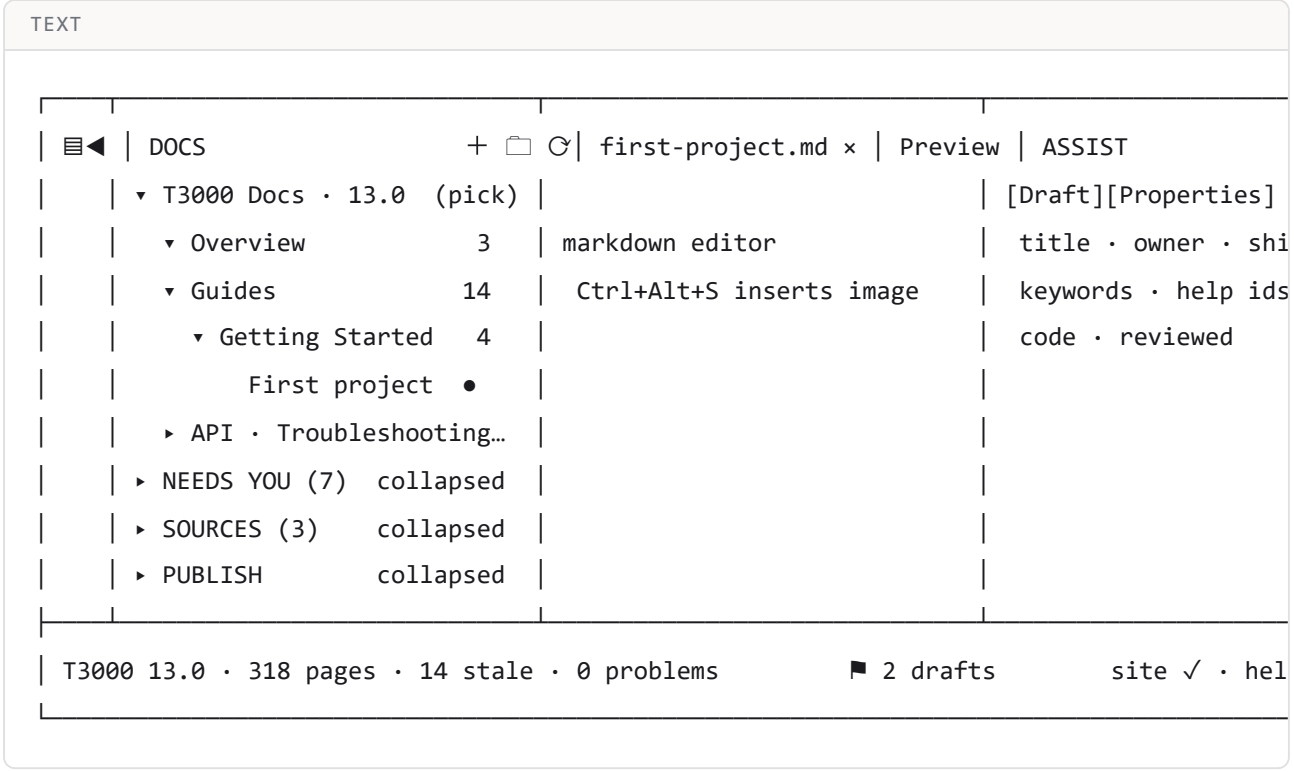
Create writes `documents`, `doc_sources`, `recipes` and the smallest valid `docs/help/registry.json`. The six default sections are seeded for a blank project: Overview, Guides, Architecture, API, Troubleshooting, Release Notes.

D. First open (empty project)

```
┌──┬──────────────────────────┬──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ ▤◀ │ DOCS              + 🗀 ⟳ │ T3000 Documentation 13.0                          │
│  │ ▾ T3000 Docs · 13.0      │ Your project is ready. Next:                         │
│  │    (empty)               │  ① Add the first page            [ New Page ]        │
│  │ ▸ NEEDS YOU        (0)   │  ② Bring in existing material     [ Import ]         │
│  │ ▸ SOURCES          (2)   │  ③ Let the AI draft from sources  [ Draft sections ] │
│  │ ▸ PUBLISH                │                                                      │
└──┴──────────────────────────┴──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

3. The window

TEXT



Constraints from the VS Code API that shape this layout:

- A tree view cannot hold dropdowns, so **the project is the tree's first row**. Clicking it opens a quick-pick; the view title shows it too.
- The three lower views are independent panes, collapsed by default. There is no accordion behaviour.
- A text editor has no tabs: Edit and Preview use the Markdown side-by-side preview, and **Properties is a tab in the right panel**.
- Dropping on the tree reports only the row dropped on, never the gap between rows.
- The tree is **path-based**. A page id is its path under `docs/`, so `guides/getting-started/install.md` is the page `install` in the folder `getting-started`, inside `guides`. Every folder level is derived from those paths: the registry does not have to name the middle folders, and folders nest to any depth.

4. E. The Pages tree

Rows and hover icons

TEXT

```
PAGES                                              +  🗀  ⇩  ⟳  ...
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ ▾ Guides                                  14                     │
│   ▾ Getting Started                  [+][🗀][...]    ← folder hover │
│       Install                                                    │
│       First project   ●              [📷][✦][···]     ← page hover   │
│       Licensing                                                  │
│ ▾ API                                                            │
│   ▾ Data Points API                                              │
│       Scaling         ⚠  📷                                       │
│         └ ⚠ code changed since last review                       │
│         └ 📷 no image on this page                               │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

Folder row: name and page count only. Leaf row: title only.

State is a badge (● draft · ⚠ stale · 📷 no image) or a folded child, never an extra r

Hover icons: folder = + New Page · 🗀 New Folder · ... ; page = 📷 Capture · ✦ Draft

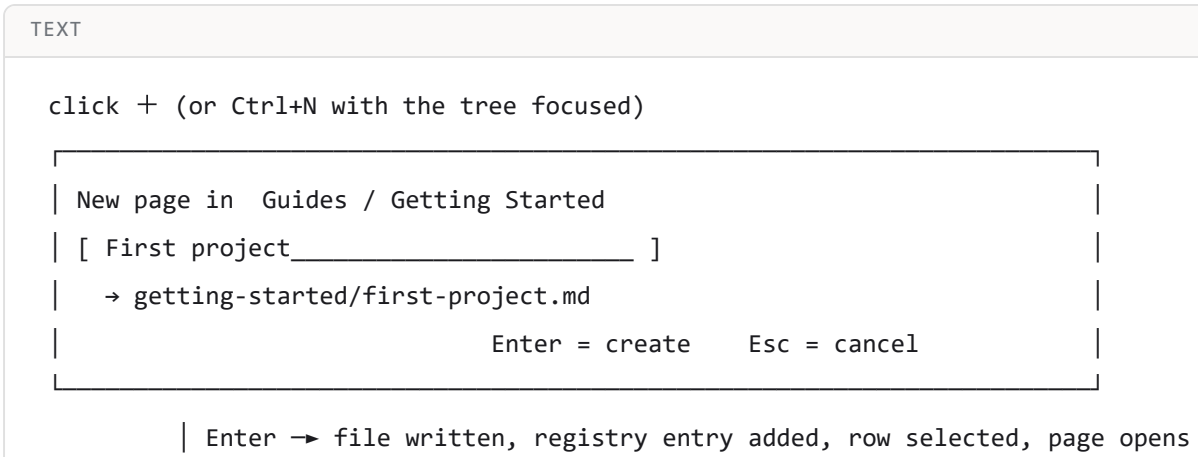
Tooltip: id · owner · audience · last change.

New page and new folder: the selection is the location

TEXT

Selected row	New Page lands…	New Folder lands…
nothing / empty space	at the root of the section	the root
a folder	inside it	inside it (a sub-folder)
a page	next to it	next to it

TEXT



Act	You type	Automatic
New Page	title	file name from the slug, kind Article, last position, registry entry, empty template
New Page ▸ Task / Reference / Troubleshooting / Release Note	title	the same, with the kind set
New Folder	folder name	the folder and its first page, since an empty chapter does not exist in the registry

The input box is a quick-input, the closest thing the extension API allows to Explorer's inline edit. Renaming in the row itself would need a change to the core of this fork and is deferred.

Context menus

TEXT

```
 on a FOLDER row              on a PAGE row                        on empty space
┌──────────────────────┐    ┌──────────────────────────────────┐    ┌──────────────────┐
│ New Page…            │    │ Open · Open to the Side          │    │ New Page…        │
│ New Folder…          │    │ ──────────────────────────────── │    │ New Folder…      │
│ Import Here…         │    │ New Page…  (sibling)             │    │ Import…          │
│ ──────────────────── │    │ New Page of a Kind  ▸            │    │ Refresh          │
│ Rename…        F2    │    │ ──────────────────────────────── │    └──────────────────┘
│ Move Up / Down       │    │ Rename File…        F2           │
│ ──────────────────── │    │ Rename Title…  Shift+F2          │
│ Reveal · Copy Path   │    │ Move Up / Down                   │
│ Delete…              │    │ ──────────────────────────────── │
└──────────────────────┘    │ Capture…  Ctrl+Alt+S             │
                            │ Paste Image  Ctrl+Alt+V          │
                            │ Draft a Change with AI…          │
                            │ Mark Reviewed                    │
                            │ ──────────────────────────────── │
                            │ Reveal · Copy Path               │
                            │ Delete…                          │
                            └──────────────────────────────────┘
```

Keys

TEXT

```
F2 rename file (old id kept as an alias)    Shift+F2 rename title only    Delete  with
Ctrl+C / Ctrl+X / Ctrl+V  copy or move rows between folders      Enter / click  open th
```

F2 moves the file, the repository's own generator writes the new registry entry, and the old id is written into `aliases` first. A project with no generator is refused, because the rename would orphan inbound links.

Drag and drop

```text
drag a page   onto a FOLDER row  → into that folder, last position
              onto a PAGE row    → into that page's folder, right after it
              onto empty space   → to the section root
multi-select  Ctrl/Shift+click, then drag together          Ctrl+drag  copies
every move    → file moves, `order` rewritten, old id kept as an alias
refused       → into itself or its own child; across projects
from the OS   → a .md, .png or .docx dropped on a folder is imported there
```

5. F. Editing a page

```text
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┬──────────────────┐
│ first-project.md        [ side-by-side Preview ]             │ ASSIST           │
│ # First project                                              │ [Draft][Ask][Props]
│ Points carry a scale factor.                                 │ Draft from…      │
│ ![Trend log](media/02-trend.png)  ◄— Ctrl+Alt+S inserts this │  ◉ source file   │
│                                                              │  ○ another page  │
│                                                              │ RESULT (diff)    │
│                                                              │ [Apply][Reject]  │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┴──────────────────┘

Capture: snip overlay → clipboard → media/NN-slug.png (warn < 1600 px, refuse > 2 MB).
No page in front → .temco/captures/ and a row in NEEDS YOU until it is attached.
Apply is one undoable edit. Drafts wait in SQLite until accepted.
```

The **Properties** tab is the form over the registry fields: title, section, order, owner, audience, ship, keywords, help ids, code, reviewed.

6. G. Needs You and the AI loop

TEXT

```
NEEDS YOU (7)
 📷 Screenshots to place (1)  row → "which page takes it?"
 ⚠ Retake these (4)           row → the page
 ○ Never reviewed (2)         row → the report
 ● Drafts waiting (2)         row → diff, Apply / Reject

source changes ─► commit summarised once (model recorded) ─► mapped to pages (code-glob
  ─► page marked stale ─► NEEDS YOU ─► Draft a Change ─► draft row ─► diff ─► Apply
```

7. H. Publish

TEXT

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│ PUBLISH · T3000 Documentation 13.0                                   │
│  ① REVIEW ──► ② BUILD ──► ③ RELEASE                                  │
│  2 waiting     site ✓ help ✗   not released                          │
│ ① drafts and changed pages: [Open diff] [Approve]                    │
│ ② Engine [DocFX ▾] ☑Website ☑PDF ☑CHM ☐ZIP   [▶ Build]               │
│    success is the artifact left behind, never the exit code          │
│ ③ Writes products/t3000/releases/13.0, latest → 13.0   [⬆ Release]   │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

8. I. Result on disk, and Temco Learn

TEXT

```
products/t3000/
  manifest.json   {id, title, version}
  docs/ guides/ api/ assets/ toc.yml docfx.json
  releases/13.0 · 12.9 · 12.8      latest → 13.0
                  │
                  ▼
Temco Learn discovers products/*  →  Home · Product page · Doc page · Downloads (Online
```

The Learn page's top navigation mirrors the project's sections, so what the writer sees in the tree is what the reader sees.

9. SQLite storage (catalog.sqlite)

```text
organisations ─┬─< repositories          cache of what GitHub listed
               │
sources ───────┤  kind git|folder|archive · remote_url · path · branch · registry_path
  │            └──< scans
  ├──< commits ──< commit_pages          sha · summary · summary_model · how: code-glo
  │ n..n (doc_sources: branch, include_glob, role)
  ▼
documents  (the PROJECT)  name · slug · version · audience · owner · origin · template
  ├── 1:1 ─ recipes          engine · config_path · script · outputs
  ├──< pages                 id · path · title · owner · reviewed_at · stale · counts
  ├──< builds ──< artifacts  status · revision · log_path  /  kind · path · bytes · sha
  ├──< releases              version · destination · files · published_at · build_id
  └──< drafts                page_id · title · body · state draft|accepted|discarded
events  at · kind · subject · detail · seen_at       meta  key/value schema version
```

10. What the extension does now

The rule this table records: **one list, one owner.** Every kind of list has exactly one surface, and a webview page never lists something a tree or a panel already lists. Everything a webview page *did* became a command on that surface.

Then	Now
views Pages, Project, Pipeline, Working Set, plus the queue declared in `temco-workbench`	Pages, Needs You, Sources, Publish — all declared by `temco-docs`
3-step New Page wizard	the selection is the location; one title box
10 webview pages (projects, project, needs, repository, documents, page, source, review, builds, releases)	2 left: **Project home** and **Release report**. The other eight commands still exist and now focus the surface that owns the list, so every button and menu item in the other modules still lands somewhere
the tree stopped at area → chapter → page	the tree is a path: folders inside folders, any depth, like Explorer
Working Set	removed (use Open Editors)
Properties as an editor panel	the right panel's **Properties** tab, beside **Draft**
publishing copied artifacts	publishing also writes `manifest.json` per product and regenerates the Learn portal
`home.ts`, `views.ts` named in `extension-design.md`	do not exist; that document now points here

11. Where the work stands

Done:

1. The three older documents carry a pointer here instead of a competing layout.
2. The four views, the queue moved out of `temco-workbench`, `Sources` / `Publish` renamed.
3. The project is the tree's first row; a new project is seeded with the six sections.
4. New Page and New Folder take their location from the selection; hover icons; multi-select drag and drop.
5. Properties is a tab in the right panel.
6. `manifest.json` is written on publish, and the Learn portal is generated from every product's manifest.

Not done, and deliberately so:

- The `temco-learn` site itself. The portal is generated by this extension and served from local storage; a real reader site is a separate repository.
- Inline rename in the tree row. It needs a change to the fork's tree widget; an input box is the closest the extension API allows.

- Dropping *between* rows. The tree reports only the row dropped on, so a drop on a page means "after it".

Open decisions

- Whether `products` becomes a table later (versions open side by side).
- Whether the six sections stay fixed, or are defined per project in `manifest.json`.